

AUDT Strategic Positioning & Product Blueprint

1. Category Definition

Category

Vendor Governance & Trust Operations (VGTO)

Definition

A Vendor Governance & Trust Operations platform enables organizations to discover, assess, govern, monitor, audit, and continuously validate the trustworthiness of third-party vendors, suppliers, SaaS applications, service providers, and AI providers.

The platform acts as the system of record for every vendor relationship and provides a unified operating model for:

- Vendor Governance
- Vendor Risk Management
- Compliance Management
- Audit Management
- Trust Operations
- Continuous Monitoring

Why This Category?

Most existing platforms start from one narrow problem:

Vendor	Starts With
Vanta	Compliance
Drata	Compliance
Sprinto	Compliance
UpGuard	Vendor Risk
SecurityScorecard	Security Ratings
Archer	Enterprise Risk
AuditBoard	Audit

AUDT starts with the vendor itself.

Everything else becomes a workflow around that vendor.

Primary Object

Vendor

Just like:

- Salesforce manages Customers
- Jira manages Tickets
- GitHub manages Repositories

AUDT manages Vendors.

Every workflow begins and ends with a vendor.

Core Outcome

Continuous Trust

The ultimate outcome is not compliance.

The ultimate outcome is trust.

Trust is calculated from:

- Governance
 - Risk
 - Compliance
 - Audit Readiness
 - Monitoring
 - Vendor Performance
-

2. Vendor Governance & Trust Operations Lifecycle

Discover

↓

Inventory
↓
Classify
↓
Assess
↓
Risk
↓
Comply
↓
Monitor
↓
Audit
↓
Remediate
↓
Renew
↓
Offboard

This lifecycle becomes the foundation of the entire platform.

Every module should fit into one or more stages.

Stage 1 — Discover

Goal:

Identify all vendors used across the organization.

Questions:

- Who are our vendors?
- What SaaS tools do we use?
- Which vendors process company data?

Outputs:

- Vendor Inventory
 - Vendor Registry
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Stage 2 — Inventory

Goal:

Create a complete system of record.

Questions:

- Who owns the vendor?
- What contract exists?
- What data do they access?
- What is the annual spend?

Outputs:

- Vendor Master Record
 - Vendor Profile
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Stage 3 — Classify

Goal:

Determine vendor criticality.

Questions:

- Does the vendor process PII?
- Does the vendor access production systems?
- Is the vendor business critical?

Outputs:

- Vendor Tier
 - Vendor Criticality
 - Vendor Category
-

Stage 4 — Assess

Goal:

Evaluate vendor security and compliance posture.

Questions:

- SOC2?
- ISO27001?
- Security controls?
- Privacy controls?

Outputs:

- Assessments
 - Questionnaires
 - Evidence Collection
-

Stage 5 — Risk

Goal:

Calculate vendor risk.

Questions:

- What is the inherent risk?
- What is the residual risk?
- What controls reduce risk?

Outputs:

- Risk Score
 - Risk Register
 - Risk Treatment Plan
-

Stage 6 — Comply

Goal:

Demonstrate compliance.

Questions:

- Which controls apply?
- Which evidence exists?
- Which frameworks are covered?

Outputs:

- Compliance Status
 - Framework Coverage
 - Audit Readiness
-

Stage 7 — Monitor

Goal:

Continuously monitor vendor trustworthiness.

Questions:

- Has the vendor been breached?
- Has compliance expired?
- Has risk increased?

Outputs:

- Monitoring Alerts
 - Vendor Health Score
 - Continuous Assurance
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Stage 8 — Audit

Goal:

Provide assurance.

Questions:

- Was vendor assessed?
- Is evidence available?
- Were findings remediated?

Outputs:

- Audit Package
 - Auditor Workspace
 - Audit Reports
-

Stage 9 — Remediate

Goal:

Resolve issues and findings.

Outputs:

- CAPAs
 - Issues
 - Exceptions
 - Action Plans
-

Stage 10 — Renew

Goal:

Make informed renewal decisions.

Questions:

- Should we renew?
- Should we replace?
- Should we renegotiate?

Outputs:

- Renewal Recommendation
 - Vendor Performance Review
-

Stage 11 — Offboard

Goal:

Safely terminate vendor relationships.

Questions:

- Was access revoked?
- Was data deleted?
- Was the contract terminated?

Outputs:

- Offboarding Checklist
 - Data Destruction Validation
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3. AUDT Current Module Mapping

Vendor Governance

Built

- Vendor Registry
- Vendor Directory
- Vendor Ownership
- Vendor Classification
- Vendor Contacts
- Vendor Documents
- Vendor Reviews

Coverage

- Discover
 - Inventory
 - Classify
-

Compliance Management

Built

- Framework Library
- Control Library
- Evidence Repository
- Gap Analysis
- Compliance Dashboard
- Compliance Reporting

Coverage

- Assess
 - Comply
-

Risk Management

Built

- Risk Register
- Risk Assessments
- Risk Scoring
- Risk Treatment
- Findings Management

Coverage

- Risk
 - Monitor
-

Audit Management

Built

- Audit Planning
- Audit Evidence
- Findings Tracking
- Audit Reporting

Coverage

- Audit
-

Policy Governance

Built

- Policies
- Policy Reviews
- Policy Approvals
- Policy Mapping

Coverage

- Comply
 - Audit
-

Asset Intelligence

Built

- Asset Registry
- Asset Ownership
- Asset Classification

Coverage

- Inventory
 - Risk
-

AI Governance

Planned / Early

Coverage

- Assess
 - Risk
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Current Strength

AUDT already covers approximately:

- Vendor Governance
- Compliance
- Risk
- Audit
- Policies
- Assets

This places AUDT beyond a simple compliance automation platform.

4. Missing Modules To Complete The Lifecycle

Discovery Layer

Missing

- SaaS Discovery
- Shadow IT Discovery
- Vendor Discovery Engine

Priority: High

Monitoring Layer

Missing

- Continuous Vendor Monitoring
- Breach Monitoring
- Vendor News Monitoring
- Security Rating Integrations

Priority: Very High

Renewal Layer

Missing

- Contract Renewal Management
- Renewal Workflows
- Vendor Performance Scoring

Priority: High

Offboarding Layer

Missing

- Vendor Offboarding
- Data Deletion Validation
- Access Revocation Tracking

Priority: High

Collaboration Layer

Missing

- Vendor Portal
- Auditor Portal
- Evidence Request Portal

Priority: High

5. Enterprise Expansion Modules

Required to compete with Archer, ServiceNow, and MetricStream.

Enterprise Governance

- Multi Business Units
 - Multi Entity Governance
 - Delegated Administration
 - Advanced RBAC
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Enterprise Risk

- Enterprise Risk Register
 - Operational Risk
 - Strategic Risk
 - Regulatory Risk
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Business Continuity

- BCP
 - DR Planning
 - Resilience Management
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Operational Resilience

- Critical Process Mapping
- Impact Tolerance
- Dependency Mapping

Regulatory Change Management

- Regulatory Library
 - Change Tracking
 - Impact Analysis
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Workflow Engine

- Approvals
 - Escalations
 - Automation Rules
-

Enterprise Security

- SAML
 - SCIM
 - Advanced Audit Logs
 - Data Residency Controls
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6. Future Category-Leader Modules

These create differentiation rather than parity.

Trust Score™

Single trust score for every vendor.

Trust Graph™

Visual relationship graph of:

- Vendors
 - Assets
 - Risks
 - Controls
 - Policies
-

Governance Copilot™

AI governance assistant.

Capabilities:

- Vendor Summaries
 - Risk Recommendations
 - Audit Preparation
 - Compliance Guidance
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Trust Benchmarking™

Compare vendor governance posture against industry peers.

Trust Exchange™

Share vendor assessments across customers.

Similar to:

- Whistic
 - SecurityScorecard Exchange
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Trust Verification Authority™

Future vision.

Independent verification and certification layer.

Equivalent to:

- Credit Bureau for Vendor Trust
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7. Competitive Landscape

Compliance Automation

Capability	Vanta	Drata	Sprinto	AUDT
Compliance Automation	Strong	Strong	Strong	Strong
Vendor Governance	Weak	Weak	Weak	Strong
Risk Management	Medium	Medium	Medium	Strong
Audit Management	Medium	Medium	Medium	Strong
Trust Intelligence	Weak	Weak	Weak	Planned

Vendor Risk Management

Capability	UpGuard	Prevalent	Whistic	AUDT
Vendor Inventory	Strong	Strong	Strong	Strong
Vendor Assessments	Strong	Strong	Strong	Strong
Continuous Monitoring	Strong	Medium	Medium	Planned
Compliance	Medium	Medium	Weak	Strong
Audit Management	Weak	Medium	Medium	Strong

Enterprise GRC

Capability	Archer	MetricStream	ServiceNow	AUDT
Enterprise Risk	Strong	Strong	Strong	Future
Vendor Governance	Strong	Medium	Medium	Strong
Compliance	Strong	Strong	Strong	Strong
Audit	Strong	Strong	Strong	Strong
Ease of Use	Weak	Weak	Medium	Strong
AI-Native	Weak	Weak	Weak	Strong

Strategic Conclusion

AUDT should position itself as:

Vendor Governance & Trust Operations Platform

Primary Object:

Vendor

Core Outcome:

Continuous Trust

Strategic Expansion Path:

Vendor Governance → Vendor Risk → Compliance → Audit → Continuous Monitoring → Trust Intelligence
→ Enterprise Governance → Trust Network → Trust Verification Authority

This positioning allows AUDT to compete today with Vanta, Drata, Sprinto, UpGuard, and Prevalent while creating a long-term path toward Archer and ServiceNow without becoming a traditional GRC platform.